

Chinese History — Study Notes

Modern Secondary Chinese History for Non-Chinese Speaking Students · Book 3

How to use these notes

These notes cover the full syllabus, chapter by chapter, in the same order as your textbook. Every key term, date, name and figure is kept. Each point is colour-coded by theme, and your highlighted points are marked with a star and a warm shaded box so you can revise them first.

Colour legend

- Yellow** General key facts, events, dates & outcomes
- Red** Key people, parties & political conflicts (KMT, CPC, Yuan Shikai, warlords, Lin Biao)
- Green** Key terms & named groups / turning-point actions
- Orange** Ch.2 KMT–CPC processes (United Front, Northern Expedition, Long March, Xi'an Incident)
- Blue** Course & phases of the War of Resistance
- Mixed** Spans more than one colour in your book
- ★ Priority — highlighted in your textbook (shown in a shaded box with a coloured margin rule).

Contents

Unit 1: Republic of China	2
Ch.1 1911 Revolution & Early Republic.....	3
Ch.2 KMT–CPC Co-operation & Separation.....	5
Ch.3 Japanese Invasion & War of Resistance.....	7
Ch.4 Chinese Civil War.....	9
Unit 2: People's Republic of China	11
U2 Ch.1 Founding of the PRC to 1978.....	11
U2 Ch.2 Chinese Economic Reform.....	13
Key Terms Glossary	15

Unit 1: Republic of China

Key-dates timeline

Date	Event
1894	Sun Yat-sen founds Xingzhonghui in Honolulu
1905	Tongmenghui formed in Tokyo; Three Principles of the People
10 Oct 1911	Wuchang Uprising — start of the Xinhai Revolution
1 Jan 1912	Republic of China founded; Sun Yat-sen provisional president
Feb 1912	Puyi abdicates — end of the Qing and 2,000+ years of monarchy
1913	Second Revolution against Yuan Shikai fails
1915	Japan's Twenty-one Demands; Yuan moves toward monarchy
1916	Yuan abolishes the monarchy and dies; warlord era begins
1917	Office–Council conflict; 12-day Zhang Xun Restoration
4 May 1919	May Fourth Movement after the Paris Peace Conference
Jul 1921	Communist Party of China founded
Jan 1923	Sun-Joffe Manifesto
1924	First United Front; Whampoa Military Academy (Jun 1924)
Mar 1925	Sun Yat-sen dies
Jul 1926	Northern Expedition launched under Chiang Kai-shek
Apr 1927	Chiang's Shanghai purge splits the KMT and CPC
1928	Northeast Flag Replacement — China reunified in form
1931	September 18th (Mukden) Incident
1934–35	The Long March; Zunyi Conference; base at Yan'an
Dec 1936	Xi'an Incident forces the Second United Front
7 Jul 1937	July 7th (Marco Polo Bridge) Incident — full-scale war
Dec 1937	Nanjing Massacre
1938	Battle of Wuhan
Dec 1941	Pearl Harbor; fall of Hong Kong ('Black Christmas')
1943	Cairo Declaration
15 Aug 1945	Japan surrenders; China wins the War of Resistance
10 Oct 1945	Double Tenth Agreement (Chongqing)
Jun 1946	All-out Civil War breaks out
1948–49	Three major campaigns: Liao-Shen, Huaihai,

	Beiping-Tianjin
Apr 1949	PLA crosses the Yangtze and takes Nanjing
late 1949	KMT retreats to Taiwan

Ch.1 1911 Revolution & Early Republic

Chapter summary

- ◆ Sun Yat-sen's groups (Xingzhonghui 1894, Tongmenghui 1905) and the Three Principles of the People drove the revolution.
- ◆ The Wuchang Uprising (10 Oct 1911) toppled the Qing; the Republic of China was founded on 1 Jan 1912 and Puyi abdicated in Feb 1912.
- ◆ Yuan Shikai seized power, attempted monarchy, and fell in the National Protection War; after his death warlords split China.
- ◆ Diplomatic humiliation (Twenty-one Demands; 1919 Paris Peace Conference) sparked the May Fourth and New Culture Movements.
- ◆ Hong Kong was central to the revolution, and society modernised through vernacular writing and feminism.

Revolutionary Movement & the 1911 Revolution

- ▶ **Decline of the Qing** Internal problems and external pressure caused the Qing's steady decline; the Self-Strengthening Movement and Hundred Days' Reform both failed, so revolutionaries believed only overthrowing the Qing could save China. Sun Yat-sen was the pioneer of the revolutionary movement.
- ▶ **Xingzhonghui (1894)** Sun Yat-sen founded Xingzhonghui — the first revolutionary group of modern China — in Honolulu in 1894, and set up its headquarters in Hong Kong in 1895.
- ▶ **Tongmenghui (1905)** In 1905 Sun united Xingzhonghui, Huaxinghui and Guangfuhui to form the Tongmenghui in Tokyo, Japan, and proposed the Three Principles of the People as its guiding ideology.
- ▶ **Three Principles of the People** San Min Zhuyi: (1) Nationalism — overthrow the Qing and end foreign invasion; (2) Democracy — abolish the monarchy and set up a republic protecting people's rights; (3) People's Livelihood — equalise land rights and narrow the rich–poor gap.
- ▶ **Railway Protection Movement** May 1911: the Qing's policy of nationalising railways provoked opposition (esp. Hubei); New Army troops were sent to Sichuan, weakening Hubei's defence and giving revolutionaries their chance.
- ▶ **Wuchang Uprising** 10 Oct 1911: revolutionaries rose in Hubei, took Wuchang and set up the Hubei Military Government; over half the provinces declared independence. Because it fell in the Xinhai year it is called the Xinhai (1911) Revolution.
- ▶ **Founding of the Republic** Dec 1911: provincial representatives elected Sun Yat-sen provisional president in Nanjing; on 1 Jan 1912 he proclaimed the Republic of China. In Feb 1912 Yuan Shikai forced the last emperor Puyi to abdicate, ending the Qing and 2,000+ years of monarchy.

- **Significance of 1911 Revolution** It overthrew the corrupt Qing and ended the absolute monarchy that had ruled China for more than 2,000 years, beginning a republican era and promoting political and cultural modernisation.

The Role of Hong Kong

- **Role of Hong Kong** HK (under British rule, beyond the Qing's reach, well-developed and close to south China) was where Sun's revolutionary thought originated, plus an activity centre, logistics base, fundraising place and propaganda place (the China Daily, founded 1900).

Early Republican Politics — Yuan Shikai & the Warlords

- ★ **Yuan Shikai takes power** Sun Yat-sen handed over the provisional presidency to Beiyang Army leader Yuan Shikai in order to end the rule of the Qing Dynasty; Yuan was inaugurated in Beijing and achieved national unification.
- ★ **Yuan's abuses** Relying on his strong military and financial strength, Yuan Shikai borrowed money from foreign countries without permission to expand his personal power.
- ★ **Second Revolution** The KMT launched the Second Revolution (1913) against Yuan, but was weak in military strength and scattered in fighting, so it ended in failure.
- ★ **Yuan restores the monarchy** Yuan Shikai restored the monarchy and made himself emperor (reign title 'Hongxian', 1 Jan 1916); in May 1915 he had accepted Japan's Twenty-one Demands in exchange for support.
- ★ **National Protection War** Cai E raised the National Protection Army in Yunnan and launched the National Protection War; under pressure Yuan abolished the monarchy and died soon after (June 1916).
- ★ **Warlord cliques** After Yuan's death the Beiyang Army split into the Anhui Clique (Duan Qirui), the Zhili Clique (Feng Guozhang) and the Fengtian Clique (Zhang Zuolin), who fought for the central government.
- ★ **Southern warlords** Southern warlords also rose in the Anti-Yuan Movement; the more powerful were the Yunnan Clique (Tang Jiyao) and the Guangxi Clique (Lu Rongting).
- ★ **Office vs Council conflict** 1917: a dispute over joining WWI set premier Duan Qirui against President Li Yuanhong — the 'Conflict between the Presidential Office and the State Council'.
- ★ **Zhang Xun Restoration** Li Yuanhong called in Zhang Xun to mediate, but Zhang restored the emperor Puyi; Duan Qirui then attacked Beijing and Zhang Xun was defeated and fled. The restoration lasted only 12 days.
- ★ **Constitutional Protection** Li Yuanhong resigned and Duan Qirui regained real power but refused to restore the Provisional Constitution; Sun Yat-sen set up the 'Constitutional Protection Junta' in Guangzhou, but the campaign failed as the southwestern warlords lacked sincerity.

Warlord cliques at a glance

Clique	Leader	Region
Anhui Clique	Duan Qirui	North China
Zhili Clique	Feng Guozhang	North China
Fengtian Clique	Zhang Zuolin	Northeast China
Yunnan Clique	Tang Jiyao	Yunnan (southwest)
Guangxi Clique	Lu Rongting	Guangxi (south)

Diplomatic Setbacks & the May Fourth Movement

- ★ **WWI & Shandong** During WWI Japan declared war on Germany and sent troops to Shandong to seize Germany's rights there.
- ★ **Twenty-one Demands** Japan presented the 'Twenty-one Demands' to Yuan Shikai (1915), seeking Germany's Shandong rights, control in Manchuria/Inner Mongolia, and Japanese advisors; Yuan accepted most of them.
- ★ **Paris Peace Conference** As a victor China attended the 1919 Paris Peace Conference and asked to recover its rights in Shandong, but the Powers sided with Japan and China's request was denied.
- ★ **May Fourth Movement** On 4 May 1919 more than 3,000 students from Peking University and other colleges gathered at Tiananmen Square; nationwide protests led China's delegates to refuse to sign the peace treaty with Germany (28 June).
- ★ **Impact of May Fourth** China became more independent and autonomous in diplomacy, more people were awakened, and Marxism was widely spread, leading to the founding of the CPC.

Social & Cultural Change

- ★ **Vernacular language** The New Culture Movement promoted vernacular (baihua) writing ('my hand writes what my mouth says'); Hu Shi (1917, New Youth) and Chen Duxiu led it, and Lu Xun pioneered vernacular fiction (Diary of a Madman). In 1920 the Beiyang Government required vernacular textbooks.
- ★ **New Culture ideas** Western ideas — natural human rights and equality between men and women — were introduced, promoting women's liberation, rights and education and attacking traditional concepts such as the 'three obediences and four virtues'.
- ▶ **Rise of feminism** Through the New Culture and May Fourth movements women gained ground in political rights (provinces recognised equality), social rights (freedom of marriage/divorce), economic rights (employment), and education — Peking University admitted women in 1920 and the 1922 New School System gave equal education.

Ch.2 KMT-CPC Co-operation & Separation

Chapter summary

- ◆ The First United Front (1924) rested on the Three Great Policies, supported by the Soviets and the Whampoa Academy.
- ◆ The Northern Expedition (1926) defeated the warlords; Chiang's April 1927 Shanghai purge split the KMT and CPC.
- ◆ China was reunified 'in form' in 1928 (Northeast Flag Replacement).
- ◆ The CPC built rural bases (Jinggangshan, Red Army), survived five encirclement campaigns and the Long March (1934–35).
- ◆ The Xi'an Incident (Dec 1936) forced the Second United Front against Japan.

The First United Front

- ★ **Background to First United Front** Sun Yat-sen needed external help to build his own army, overthrow the warlords and unify China; the CPC (founded July 1921 with Comintern help) was small and weak, so on Comintern advice it united with the KMT.
- ★ **Sun's aim** To overthrow the warlords and unify China, Sun needed external help, his own revolutionary army and reform of the disorganised KMT.
- ★ **Sun-Joffe Manifesto** Sun formed the policy 'Alliance with the Soviets, admission of the Communists'; in Jan 1923 he and Soviet emissary Adolf Joffe issued the Sun-Joffe Manifesto, opening the way to the United Front.
- ★ **Three Great Policies** At the KMT's First National Congress (Guangzhou, Jan 1924) the policy became 'Alliance with the Soviets, admission of the Communists, and assist the workers and peasants', aiming to bring down the warlords and imperialism.
- ★ **Soviet support** The KMT hired the Russian Mikhail Borodin as political advisor; CPC members could join the KMT as individuals; slogans included 'down with the warlords' and against imperialism.
- ★ **Whampoa Academy** June 1924: with Soviet help the KMT set up the Whampoa (Huangpu) Military Academy in Guangzhou, with Chiang Kai-shek as principal and Zhou Enlai (CPC) as deputy head of political education.

The Northern Expedition & the Split

- ▶ **Death of Sun / Nationalist Govt** March 1925: Sun Yat-sen died in Beijing; in July the KMT set up a Nationalist Government in Guangzhou and raised the National Revolutionary Army, unifying Guangdong and Guangxi.
- ★ **Northern Expedition** July 1926: Chiang Kai-shek, as Commander-in-Chief, launched the Northern Expedition in three directions, taking Changsha, Wuhan, Shanghai and Nanjing to defeat the warlords.
- ★ **Shanghai purge (the split)** April 1927: Chiang Kai-shek launched a purge to kill the Communists in Shanghai, splitting the KMT and CPC and interrupting the Northern Expedition.
- ★ **Reunification in form** After reuniting, the army resumed in 1928 and took Beijing; in Dec 1928 Zhang Xueliang (Northeast) accepted the jurisdiction of the Nanjing Nationalist Government (Northeast Flag Replacement) — the Northern Expedition was accomplished and China was reunified in form.

CPC Bases & the Long March

- ▶ **CPC moves to countryside** After the split, CPC uprisings in cities (Nanchang, Autumn Harvest) failed, so the CPC moved to the countryside.
- ★ **Jinggangshan & Red Army** Oct 1927: Mao Zedong led remaining forces to set up the first rural revolutionary base of the CPC at Jinggangshan and formed the Red Army; by 1931 the CPC set up the 'Chinese Soviet Republic' at Ruijin, Jiangxi.
- ★ **Five Encirclement Campaigns** From 1930 Chiang Kai-shek launched five military encirclement campaigns against the CPC's bases.

- ★ **Long March** 1934: the Red Army abandoned its Jiangxi base and began the Long March; the Zunyi Conference (1935) established Mao Zedong's leadership; in Oct 1935 the army reached and built a new base at Yan'an, Shaanxi.

The Second United Front

- ★ **Background to Second United Front** In the 1930s Japan intensified its aggression; Chiang Kai-shek insisted on eliminating the CPC before resisting Japan, while the CPC urged 'stop fighting each other and fight Japan'.
- ★ **Xi'an Incident (Dec 1936)** Zhang Xueliang and Yang Hucheng launched a military remonstrance in Shaanxi/Xi'an and put Chiang Kai-shek under house arrest; after mediation (Song Meiling, Zhou Enlai) Chiang agreed to stop the civil war and fight Japan.
- ▶ **Second United Front formed** After the July 7th Incident (1937) the CPC issued a co-operation declaration; the Red Army was reorganised into the Eighth Route Army (northwest) and the New Fourth Army (south), forming the Second United Front.

Hong Kong & the Strikes

- ▶ **HK — Seamen's Strike (1922)** The Chinese Seamen's Union struck for higher wages; ~120,000 joined, the Kowloon-Canton Railway was suspended and the 'Sha Tin Massacre' occurred; the 56-day strike ended 8 March with a wage rise.
- ▶ **HK — Canton-HK Strike (1925-26)** After the May 30th Incident (Shanghai) and the Shaker Massacre (Guangzhou), ~250,000 struck and a 'Canton-Hong Kong Strike Committee' blockaded HK's trade; the strike lasted one year and four months.

Ch.3 Japanese Invasion & War of Resistance

Chapter summary

- ◆ Japanese aggression escalated from the September 18th Incident (1931) and Manchukuo to the July 7th Incident (1937).
- ◆ China fought major battles (Shanghai, Wuhan), then a protracted war of stalemate from the mountainous southwest.
- ◆ The Nanjing Massacre (Dec 1937) killed as many as 300,000.
- ◆ Pearl Harbor (1941) brought China into the Allied Powers; Japan surrendered on 15 Aug 1945.
- ◆ Victory abolished the unequal treaties, won a UN Security Council seat and returned Taiwan; Hong Kong fell ('Black Christmas').

Japanese Aggression (1931-36)

- ▶ **September 18th Incident (1931)** Japan staged the September 18th (Mukden) Incident in 1931; the Chinese army did not resist and Japan occupied all of Northeast China within half a year.
- ▶ **January 28th Incident & Manchukuo** Japan attacked Shanghai in the January 28th Incident (1932); in 1932 it set up the puppet state of Manchukuo in the Northeast, with the last emperor Puyi as figurehead but real power held by Japan.

Outbreak & Course of the War

- ★ **July 7th Incident (1937)** On 7 July 1937 the Japanese demanded entry to Wanping (near Luguoqiao / Marco Polo Bridge, southwest of Beiping) to search for a missing soldier; refused, they bombarded the town and Chinese defenders resisted — the July 7th / Luguoqiao Incident.
- ★ **Full-scale resistance begins** Japan sent further troops and the Nationalist Government called on all the people to resist, beginning China's full-scale War of Resistance.
- ★ **Course of the war** Major battles were the Battle of Shanghai and Battle of Wuhan; Japan occupied huge parts of North, East and Central China in just over a year, then China retreated to the mountainous southwest, using the natural barrier for a strong defence — entering a phase of stalemate.
- ★ **China's strategy** Left helpless, China used its vast territory and large population to fight a protracted war and a war of attrition, plus guerrilla warfare, to contain Japan.

Major Battles

Battle	Dates	Forces (China vs Japan)	Outcome
Battle of Shanghai	Aug–Nov 1937	~750,000 vs ~250,000	NRA retreated after >3 months (~250,000 Chinese casualties)
Battle of Wuhan	Jun–Oct 1938	~1,000,000 vs ~400,000	NRA retreated after >4 months; capital moved to Chongqing

The Nanjing Massacre

- ★ **Nanjing Massacre (Dec 1937)** After capturing Nanjing the Japanese carried out a six-week massacre; as many as 300,000 soldiers and civilians (women, children, defenceless soldiers) were shot, executed, burned or buried alive — the figure of 300,000 is supported by the post-war Nanjing Military Tribunal.

The Pacific War & Allied Victory

- ★ **Axis Powers** After WWII began (1939), Germany, Italy and Japan formed the 'Axis Powers'.
- ★ **Pearl Harbor / Pacific War** Dec 1941: Japan's sneak attack on the US base at Pearl Harbor, Hawaii, triggered the Pacific War; the US immediately declared war on Japan.
- ★ **Allied Powers** China joined the 'Allied Powers' with the US, Britain and the Soviet Union; in early 1942 the China Theater was set up with Chiang Kai-shek as supreme commander, and China received military aid from the Allies.
- ★ **Chinese Expeditionary Force** The Chinese Expeditionary Force was sent into Burma to rescue the besieged British troops and reopen the Yunnan-Burma Road.
- ★ **Turning point** After the Pacific War began, allied with the US, Britain and the USSR, China improved its fighting capacity and morale and reversed the situation in the War of Resistance.
- ★ **End of the war** May 1945: Germany surrendered; early Aug 1945 the US dropped atomic bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki and the USSR entered the Northeast; on 15 Aug 1945 Japan declared unconditional surrender and China won.

Significance of Victory

- ★ **Enhanced international standing** In 1942 Britain and the US gave up their privileges and abolished the unequal treaties; in 1945 the UN was established and China became a permanent member of the Security Council (with the US, Britain, France, USSR) with veto power.
- ★ **Cairo Declaration** At the Cairo Conference (1943, Chiang Kai-shek, Roosevelt, Churchill) the Cairo Declaration stated Japan must return all occupied territories — including Taiwan and the Pescadores Islands — to China.

Hong Kong in the War

- ▶ **HK support before occupation** Before the occupation HK was a back-up and refuge for the resistance; Song Qingling's 'China Defense League' raised funds and supplies; in 1938 the Kowloon-Canton Railway moved 52,835 tonnes of weapons to the Mainland in 31 weeks.
- ★ **Fall of Hong Kong** Japan attacked from 8 Dec 1941, broke the Girders Line and landed on HK Island; on 25 Dec 1941 Governor Mark A. Young surrendered ('Black Christmas'). The Japanese Occupation lasted 'three years and eight months'.
- ▶ **HK anti-Japanese forces** The Hong Kong Independent Battalion (est. Sai Kung 1942, part of the Dongjiang Column) rescued hundreds of wanted figures; the British Army Aid Group (founded 1942 by Lindsay Ride) rescued POWs and gathered intelligence. British rule was restored end-Aug 1945.

Ch.4 Chinese Civil War

Chapter summary

- ◆ Post-war conflict over the Japanese surrender led to failed talks (Double Tenth Agreement, Oct 1945) and all-out war (1946).
- ◆ The KMT was stronger at first but collapsed through hyperinflation, lost support and military defeat.
- ◆ The PLA won the three major campaigns (1948–49) and crossed the Yangtze to take Nanjing.
- ◆ The KMT retreated to Taiwan (late 1949) and the CPC won.

Breakdown & Peace Talks

- ★ **Post-war KMT–CPC tension** During the war the CPC expanded; by 1946 it held ~2 million km², ~120 million people and an army of ~1.3 million. After victory, KMT–CPC conflict broke out over accepting the Japanese surrender and collecting weapons.
- ★ **Chongqing negotiations** With US mediation, Chiang Kai-shek (KMT) and Mao Zedong (CPC) negotiated from Aug 1945 in Chongqing and signed the Double Tenth Agreement on 10 Oct 1945.
- ★ **Outbreak of civil war** In early 1946 both sides signed an Armistice and held the Political Consultative Conference, but talks broke down and all-out Civil War broke out (June 1946).

Course of the War

- ★ **Early advantage** In the early days the KMT army was superior in military strength and equipment (US-backed) and even took the CPC base at Yan'an; after a year the CPC switched from defence to offence.

Factor	KMT (Nationalists)	CPC (Communists)
Territory	~7.3 million km ²	~2 million km ²
Population	~340 million	~120 million
Troops	~4.3 million	~1.3 million
Areas held	Major cities & the developed east; key railways	Rural areas & small towns of North & Northeast China; some mountainous regions
Foreign support	United States	Soviet Union
Army name	National Revolutionary Army	Renamed the People's Liberation Army (PLA) from 1946

- ▶ **Devaluation of banknotes** The KMT printed money recklessly, causing hyperinflation; the Aug 1948 Gold Yuan reform soon collapsed, prices rose several times a day and the public lost confidence — a key reason for KMT failure.

- ★ **Three major campaigns** Dec 1948–Jan 1949: the PLA defeated the main KMT forces in the Liao-Shen, Huaihai and Beiping-Tianjin campaigns; the KMT lost almost all its elite and the CPC controlled most areas north of the Yangtze.
- ★ **KMT retreat to Taiwan** April 1949: the PLA crossed the Yangtze and took Nanjing; the Nationalist Government fled to Guangzhou, Chongqing, Chengdu and finally retreated to Taiwan (late 1949). The 3-year Civil War ended in CPC victory.

Unit 2: People's Republic of China

Key-dates timeline

Date	Event
1 Oct 1949	Mao proclaims the founding of the PRC
1950	Land Reform; Korean War ('Resist America, Aid Korea'); Sino-Soviet Treaty
1951	Three Antis Movement
1952	Five Antis Movement
1953–57	First Five-Year Plan
1953	Zhou Enlai's Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence
1955	Bandung (Asian-African) Conference
1958	Great Leap Forward and the Three Red Banners
1959–61	Three-year Difficult Period (famine)
1960	USSR withdraws its experts from China
May 1966	Circular Notice — official start of the Cultural Revolution
1969	Zhenbao Island clash
1971	PRC's UN seat restored; Ping-Pong Diplomacy
1972	Nixon visits China; Sino-Japanese relations established
Dec 1978	Third Plenary Session — Reform and Opening-up
1979	Sino-US diplomatic relations; first foreign-run factory
1980	First Special Economic Zones: Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Shantou, Xiamen
1992	Opening expanded to riverside, border and inland cities
2010	China becomes the world's second largest economy

U2 Ch.1 Founding of the PRC to 1978

Chapter summary

- ◆ The PRC was founded on 1 Oct 1949; early campaigns consolidated the regime (Land Reform, Korean War, Five-Year Plan).
- ◆ The Great Leap Forward (1958) and false reports caused the Three-year Difficult Period famine (1959–61).
- ◆ The Cultural Revolution (1966–76) brought the Red Guards, the Lin Biao incident and the Gang of Four.
- ◆ Diplomacy moved from 'Leaning to One Side' to the Sino-Soviet split, then rapprochement with the US (1972) and the UN seat (1971).
- ◆ Hong Kong kept close ties with the Mainland (trade window, Dongjiang water, 1967 Riot).

Founding & Early Years

- ★ **Forming the new government** April 1949 the PLA took Nanjing; in Sept 1949 the CPPCC met in Beijing and decided the state's name (PRC), capital (Beijing), flag (five-star red), anthem ('March of the Volunteers') and elected Mao Zedong as Chairman.
- ★ **Founding of the PRC** On 1 October 1949 Mao Zedong proclaimed the founding of the PRC from the Tiananmen Tower in Beijing; campaigns followed to consolidate the regime, restore social order and recover the economy.
- ▶ **Early campaigns (1950–57)** Land Reform (1950), Suppressing Counter-revolutionaries (1950), Three Antis (1951: anti-corruption/waste/bureaucracy), Five Antis (1952: against capitalists), First Five-Year Plan (1953–57: heavy industry + state ownership), and the Anti-Rightist Campaign (1957).

The Great Leap Forward

- ★ **Great Leap Forward (1958)** After over-fulfilling the First Five-Year Plan, leaders aimed to become rich and powerful quickly and surpass capitalist countries such as the US and Britain; they launched the 'Three Red Banners' (General Line, Great Leap Forward, People's Commune) with backyard furnaces for steel.
- ★ **False reports** Localities made false reports on grain output to appear to meet targets, causing widespread exaggeration.
- ▶ **Three-year Difficult Period** Steel obsession drew labour from farming; agricultural output dropped and, with natural disasters, caused the 'Three-year Difficult Period' (1959–61) famine. Mao stepped back and Liu Shaoqi led economic readjustment and recovery.

The Cultural Revolution

- ★ **Cultural Revolution — cause** After the failure of the Three Red Banners, Mao's power declined; he believed some leaders had taken the 'capitalist road' and launched the Cultural Revolution to regain power.
- ★ **Official start (1966)** In May 1966 the CPC passed the 'Circular Notice' (and formed the Cultural Revolution Group), marking the official start of the Cultural Revolution; in Aug 1966 Mao's poster 'Bombarding the Headquarters' targeted Liu Shaoqi.
- ★ **Red Guards** Red Guard organisations arrested people everywhere and attacked party and government organs; educated youths were sent 'up to the mountains and down to the countryside'.
- ★ **Lin Biao incident (1971)** Lin Biao, named Mao's successor in 1969, failed in an armed coup and died in a plane crash while fleeing in 1971.
- ★ **Gang of Four** The Gang of Four (Jiang Qing, Wang Hongwen, Zhang Chunqiao, Yao Wenxuan) launched the Anti-Lin, Anti-Confucius Campaign (1974); they were arrested in 1976 after Mao's death, ending the Cultural Revolution.
- ▶ **Impact of Cultural Revolution** It paralysed administration, nearly destroyed the legal system, hit the economy (shortages, lower living standards), damaged cultural relics and education, and fostered a blind personality cult of Mao.

Diplomacy 1949–1978

- ▶ **1950s diplomacy — Leaning to One Side** On founding, the PRC adopted 'Leaning to One Side' toward the USSR; the 1950 Sino-Soviet Treaty of Friendship brought Soviet military/economic aid and experts, but relations cooled after Khrushchev.
- ▶ **Korean War** When the Korean War broke out (1950) China launched 'Resist America, Aid Korea', sending the Chinese People's Volunteer Army against US-led UN forces; the US imposed a trade embargo and containment. An armistice was signed at Panmunjom in 1953.
- ▶ **Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence** In 1953 Zhou Enlai proposed the Five Principles: mutual respect for sovereignty/territorial integrity, mutual non-aggression, non-interference, equality and mutual benefit, and peaceful coexistence.
- ▶ **Bandung Conference (1955)** Zhou Enlai attended the Asian-African (Bandung) Conference and advanced 'seeking common ground while reserving differences', strengthening ties with Asian and African countries.
- ▶ **1960s — Sino-Soviet split** From 1956 China and the USSR diverged; in 1960 the USSR cut off aid and withdrew its experts; border clashes followed, and the 1969 Zhenbao Island clash brought relations to the brink of a split.
- ▶ **1960s — isolation** At odds with both superpowers and disrupted by the Cultural Revolution (foreign ministry seized, ambassadors recalled), China turned to the 'middle zones', signing border treaties (Burma, Nepal) and ties with France and Cuba.
- ▶ **1970s — rapprochement with US** To counter the USSR, China improved ties with the US: 'Ping-Pong Diplomacy' (1971), Nixon's visit and the Joint Communiqué (1972); the two announced full diplomatic relations from 1 Jan 1979.
- ▶ **Return to the UN (1971)** In 1971 the UN General Assembly restored the PRC's lawful seat, replacing the KMT/Taiwan; China's international status rose.
- ▶ **Ties with Japan (1972)** After Nixon's visit, Japanese PM Kakuei Tanaka visited China in 1972 and the two issued a joint communiqué establishing diplomatic relations.
- ▶ **Three Worlds Theory** Mao's theory: First World = US & USSR (hegemonist superpowers); Second World = developed countries; Third World = developing countries, which should unite, with Second-World support, against the First World.

Hong Kong & the Mainland

- ▶ **HK–Mainland ties** Under 'long-term planning and full utilization' China shelved recovering HK; HK gained Mainland capital/labour, became the 'window' of China's foreign trade during the Korean-War embargo (driving its shift to manufacturing), and received Dongjiang water (1965). The 1967 Riot and the 1971 Defend-the-Diaoyu-Islands and 'Know the Motherland' movements stirred national feeling.

U2 Ch.2 Chinese Economic Reform

Chapter summary

- ◆ The Third Plenary Session (Dec 1978) launched Reform and Opening-up under Deng Xiaoping.
- ◆ Rural reform (household responsibility system), enterprise reform and Special Economic Zones (from 1980) drove growth.

- ◆ China became the world's second largest economy (2010) with rising living standards.
- ◆ China expanded its global role (WTO, APEC, G20) and its diplomatic, economic and cultural status.
- ◆ Hong Kong played pioneering, promoting and bridging roles in the reform.

Background & Aims

- ▶ **Background of reform** After the Cultural Revolution, Deng Xiaoping became the core leader; at the Third Plenary Session of the 11th Central Committee (Dec 1978) the policy of 'Reform and Opening-up' (internal reform, external opening-up) was confirmed.
- ▶ **Objectives** Deng proposed building 'socialism with Chinese characteristics' — pursuing China's own course, achieving common prosperity, and modernising agriculture, industry, national defence and science & technology.

Reform Measures

- ▶ **Rural reform** The household responsibility system let peasants contract land and make their own decisions, paying a set amount to the government and keeping the rest; purchase prices of farm products were raised to boost output.
- ▶ **Enterprise reform** State-owned enterprises were given management rights and allowed to go bankrupt/reorganise to improve efficiency; township, village and private enterprises were encouraged.
- ▶ **Special Economic Zones** From 1980 four SEZs were set up — Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Shantou (Guangdong) and Xiamen (Fujian) — to attract foreign capital, technology and management; coastal cities opened from 1984 and opening expanded all-round from 1992.

Results & China's Global Role

- ▶ **Effectiveness** The economy grew rapidly; GDP rose sharply (≈410,000 hundred-million RMB by 2010) and living standards improved; since 2010 China has been the world's second largest economy.
- ▶ **China's global role** China joined UN peacekeeping, the WTO, APEC and the G20, founded the SCO, and signed arms-control conventions; its GDP share of the world rose from 1.8% (1978) to 9.5% (2010).
- ▶ **International status** By 2000 China had diplomatic relations with 171 countries; the IMF and World Bank raised China's voting share; Chinese-learning grew worldwide via Confucius Institutes, and the 2008 Olympics and 2010 World Expo boosted cultural exchange.

The Role of Hong Kong

- ▶ **Role of Hong Kong** HK played a pioneering role (early investors/'firsts' like the 1980 first joint venture), a promoting role (largest source of FDI, ~40–60% of Mainland FDI; largest offshore fund-raising centre), and a bridging/demonstration role (its market-economy model guided the Mainland's move to a socialist market economy and Free Trade Zones).

Key Terms Glossary

Ch.1 1911 Revolution & Early Republic

Xingzhonghui	The first revolutionary group of modern China, founded by Sun Yat-sen in Honolulu in 1894.
Tongmenghui	Revolutionary alliance formed in Tokyo in 1905 by uniting Xingzhonghui, Huaxinghui and Guangfuhui.
Three Principles of the People (San Min Zhuyi)	Nationalism, Democracy and People's Livelihood — the guiding ideology of the revolution.
Xinhai (1911) Revolution	The revolution begun by the Wuchang Uprising (10 Oct 1911) that overthrew the Qing and ended the monarchy.
Second Revolution	The KMT's failed 1913 revolt against Yuan Shikai after he illegally borrowed foreign money.
National Protection War	Cai E's crusade (National Protection Army, Yunnan) against Yuan Shikai's monarchy.
Hongxian	The reign title of Yuan Shikai's short-lived empire (proclaimed 1 Jan 1916).
Twenty-one Demands	Japan's 1915 demands on China, mostly accepted by Yuan in exchange for support; cause of the 'Shandong Problem'.
May Fourth Movement	Nationwide patriotic movement from 4 May 1919 after China's diplomatic failure at Paris; spread Marxism.
Vernacular language writing	Written language based on spoken Chinese ('my hand writes what my mouth says'), promoted by Hu Shi & Chen Duxiu.
Three obediences and four virtues	Traditional moral code imposed on women, attacked by the New Culture Movement.

Ch.2 KMT–CPC Co-operation & Separation

Comintern	The Communist International, set up by Soviet Russia to spread communism; helped found the CPC (1921).
Sun-Joffe Manifesto	1923 joint declaration by Sun Yat-sen and Adolf Joffe opening KMT–Soviet/CPC co-operation.
Three Great Policies	'Alliance with the Soviets, admission of the Communists, assist the workers and peasants' (1924).
Whampoa (Huangpu) Academy	KMT military academy (1924, Guangzhou); principal Chiang Kai-shek, deputy political head Zhou Enlai.
Northern Expedition	1926 campaign led by Chiang Kai-shek to defeat the warlords and unify China.
Northeast Flag Replacement	Zhang Xueliang's 1928 acceptance of Nanjing's authority, completing reunification 'in form'.

Five Encirclement Campaigns	Five KMT campaigns from 1930 to surround and destroy the CPC's bases.
Long March	The Red Army's 1934–35 strategic retreat from Jiangxi to Yan'an, Shaanxi.
Zunyi Conference	1935 meeting that established Mao Zedong's leadership of the CPC.
Xi'an Incident	Dec 1936 detention of Chiang Kai-shek by Zhang Xueliang & Yang Hucheng, forcing a united front against Japan.
Second United Front	KMT–CPC alliance against Japan (1937); Red Army reorganised into the Eighth Route Army and New Fourth Army.

Ch.3 Japanese Invasion & War of Resistance

September 18th (Mukden) Incident	Japan's 1931 attack leading to occupation of all Northeast China within half a year.
Manchukuo	Japanese puppet state in the Northeast (1932) with Puyi as figurehead.
July 7th / Luguoqiao Incident	Clash at the Marco Polo Bridge (7 July 1937) that began China's full-scale War of Resistance.
Phase of stalemate	Stage when Japan could no longer advance and China defended the mountainous southwest.
Nanjing Massacre	Six-week massacre (Dec 1937) of ~300,000 Chinese, confirmed by the post-war Nanjing Military Tribunal.
Axis Powers	Germany, Italy and Japan — the WWII aggressor alliance.
Allied Powers	China, the US, Britain and the USSR — the alliance against the Axis.
Pacific War	War triggered by Japan's Dec 1941 attack on Pearl Harbor; turning point bringing China Allied aid.
China Theater	Allied war zone (1942) with Chiang Kai-shek as supreme commander.
Chinese Expeditionary Force	Chinese troops sent to Burma to rescue British forces and reopen the Yunnan-Burma Road.
Cairo Declaration	1943 declaration (Chiang, Roosevelt, Churchill) that Japan must return occupied territories (incl. Taiwan).
Black Christmas	25 Dec 1941, when Governor Mark A. Young surrendered Hong Kong to Japan.

Ch.4 Chinese Civil War

Double Tenth Agreement	Agreement signed by KMT and CPC in Chongqing on 10 Oct 1945.
People's Liberation Army (PLA)	The CPC's army (so renamed from 1946).
Three major campaigns	Liao-Shen, Huaihai and Beiping-Tianjin (1948–49),

	in which the KMT lost its elite.
Gold Yuan	Currency introduced Aug 1948; its collapse fuelled hyperinflation and KMT failure.

U2 Ch.1 Founding of the PRC to 1978

CPPCC	Chinese People's Political Consultative Conference (Sept 1949) — set the new state's name, flag, anthem, capital.
Three Red Banners	The General Line, the Great Leap Forward and the People's Commune (1958).
People's Commune	Collective unit where members worked/lived together and the commune supplied all needs.
Three-year Difficult Period	1959–61 famine following the Great Leap Forward.
Circular Notice	May 1966 CPC document that officially launched the Cultural Revolution.
Red Guards	Radical youth groups that attacked party/government organs and 'old' culture.
Gang of Four	Jiang Qing, Wang Hongwen, Zhang Chunqiao, Yao Wenyuan — radicals arrested in 1976.
Leaning to One Side	China's 1950s policy of aligning with the USSR and the socialist camp.
Resist America, Aid Korea	China's 1950 intervention in the Korean War via the Volunteer Army.
Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence	Zhou Enlai's 1953 principles for handling international relations.
Ping-Pong Diplomacy	US table-tennis team's 1971 visit that thawed Sino-US relations.

U2 Ch.2 Chinese Economic Reform

Reform and Opening-up	Policy confirmed at the Third Plenary Session of the 11th Central Committee (Dec 1978).
Socialism with Chinese characteristics	Deng Xiaoping's reform goal of pursuing China's own socialist course toward common prosperity.
Household responsibility system	Rural reform letting peasants contract land, pay a set amount and keep the rest.
Special Economic Zone (SEZ)	Zones (from 1980: Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Shantou, Xiamen) to attract foreign capital, technology & management.
Socialist market economy	The market-based system China moved to from a planned economy under reform.